Beau Elson · LHP | Fastball HAA Analysis

Pitches	50.6%	14.2%	23.3%	57.1%
n = 403	Swing%	Whiff%	CSW%	Zone%

KEY FINDING

Low HAA = 3× more whiffs than High HAA

Low HAA (≈1.08°) generates 25.9% Whiff% — 3× the rate of High HAA (8.5%).

When Beau's fastball exits the hand at a lower horizontal approach angle, it arrives from the 1B side and finishes outside to RHH. That deceptive angle makes it extremely difficult to square up, driving the dramatic difference in swing-and-miss across folds.

HAA and PlateLocSide share a 0.90 correlation — the approach angle dictates where the ball ends up, not the other way around.

Low HAA (25.9% Whiff) Mid HAA (11.4% Whiff) High HAA (8.5% Whiff)

TARGET RELEASE POINT

Current RelSide: **-2.35 ft**

Target RelSide: **-2.25 ft**

Delta: **Δ = +0.10 ft (≈1.2 in toward 1B/glove side)**

Expected outcome: Whiff% → ~25.9% (from 14.2% overall)

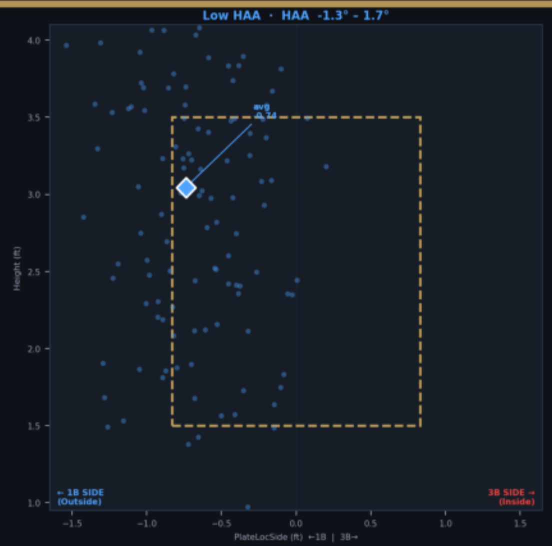
Moving toward the 1B side of the rubber lowers HAA, ball arrives from 1B side → stays outside vs RHH — the most effective approach angle.

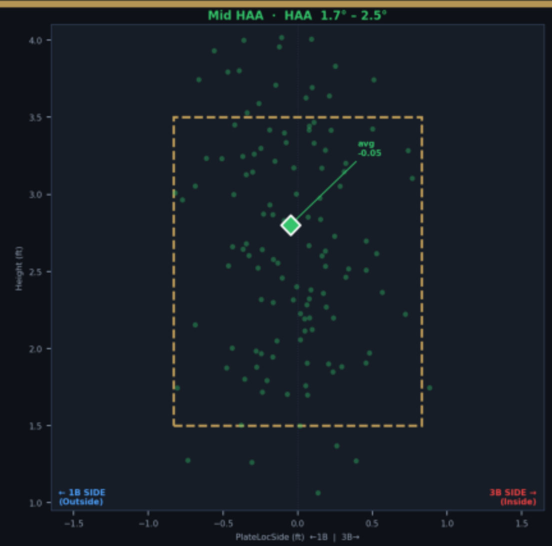
Guardrail: Zone% drops to 41.5% in Low-HAA fold. Pair with location discipline or pitch-to-contact mix.

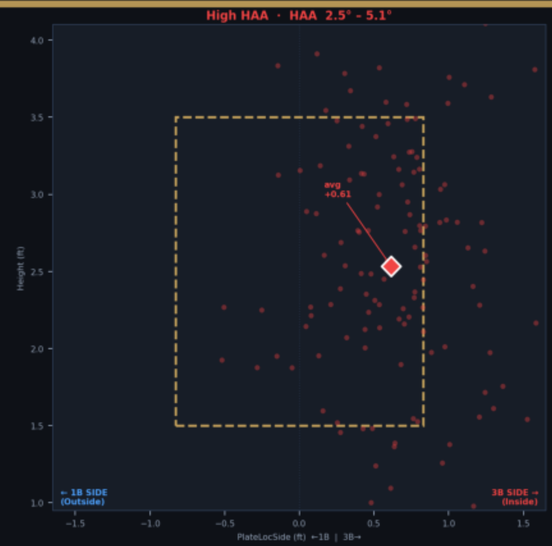
Beau Elson · HAA Fold Analysis

Elson, Beau (LHP) — Fastball HAA Fold Analysis · vs RHH Only

Fastballs split into 3 equal HAA terciles · Positive HAA = ball arriving from 3B side (inside to RHH) · Negative/low HAA = ball arrives from 1B side (outside to RHH) · Low HAA most effective







	Outside (1B side)	Middle	Inside (3B side)
N (vs RHH)	135	134	134
Avg HAA	1.08°	2.12°	3.09°
Avg Velo	89.3 mph	89.2 mph	88.9 mph
Avg Rel Side	-2.25 ft	-2.35 ft	-2.44 ft
Avg Location	-0.74 ft	-0.05 ft	+0.61 ft
Strike%	57.8%	75.4%	67.2%
Zone%	41.5%	73.9%	55.2%
CSW%	28.1%	23.1%	18.7%
Whiff%	25.9%	11.7%	8.5%

Outside (1B side): *Ball stays 1B-side / away from RHH → Most whiffs, highest CSW*

Middle: *Ball works middle of plate → Moderate outcomes*

Inside (3B side): *Ball runs inside (3B-side) to RHH → Harder to generate whiffs*

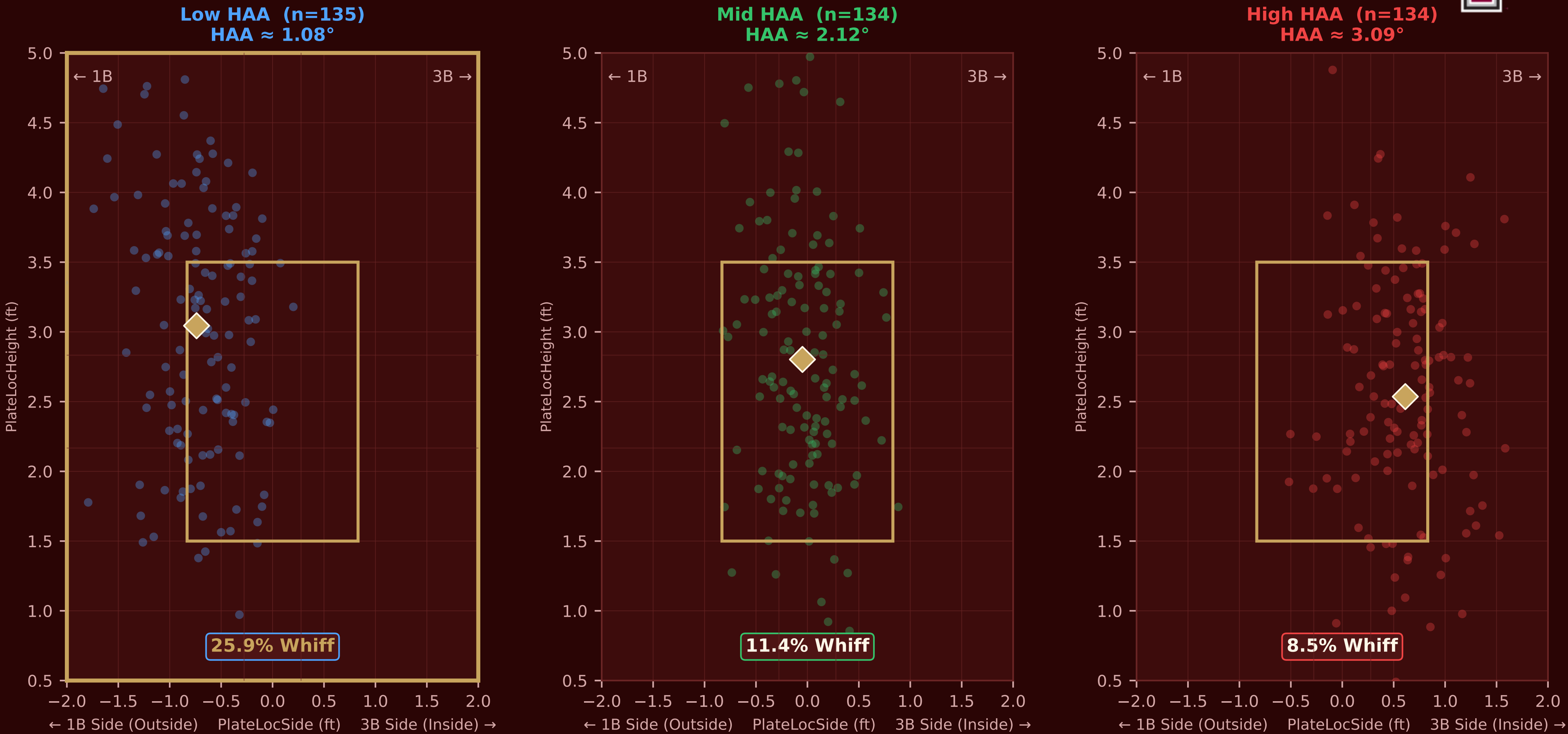
← 1B Side / Outside to RHH

3B Side / Inside to RHH →

Three HAA tercile folds (Low / Mid / High) vs RHH | Low fold: HAA ≈ 1.08° → 25.9% Whiff% · Mid fold: HAA ≈ 2.12° → 11.4% Whiff% · High fold: HAA ≈ 3.09° → 8.5% Whiff%

Generated from TrackMan data · Fordham Baseball Analytics · 2026

Beau Elson · Zone Location by HAA Fold (vs RHH)



Fold Comparison — Fastball vs RHH

Fold	N	HAA	RelS	RelH	Swing%	Whiff%	CSW%	Zone%	ZTake%	ZSwing%	OSwing%	ZCon%	OCon%
Low	135	1.08°	-2.25	5.66	40.0%	25.9%	28.1%	41.5%	35.7%	64.3%	22.8%	83.3%	55.6%
Mid	134	2.12°	-2.35	5.61	59.0%	11.4%	23.1%	73.9%	26.3%	73.7%	17.1%	90.4%	66.7%
High	134	3.09°	-2.44	5.58	53.0%	8.5%	18.7%	56.0%	24.0%	76.0%	23.7%	94.7%	78.6%

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Beau Elson · Coaching Summary & Rubber Recommendation

RUBBER SETUP RECOMMENDATION

Current Rubber Position: **-2.35 ft RelSide**

Target Rubber Position: **-2.25 ft RelSide**

Rubber Shift: **Δ = +0.10 ft ≈ 1.2 in toward 1B side of rubber**

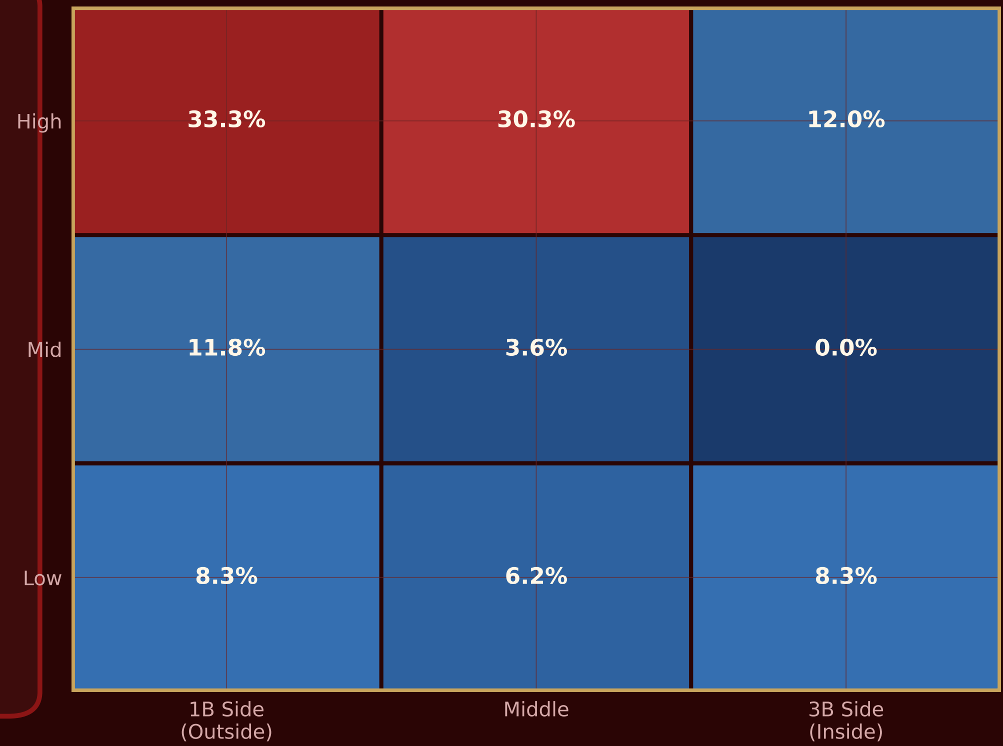
Expected Outcome: Whiff% → ~25.9% (from 14.2% overall)

Moving toward the 1B side of the rubber lowers HAA,

ball arrives from 1B side → stays outside vs RHH

— the most effective approach angle.

9-Zone Whiff% (All vs-RHH Fastballs)



STRATEGIC READ PER FOLD

LOW HAA (≈1.08°)

• Ball arrives from 1B side, finishing outside to RHH.

• 25.9% Whiff% — 3× the rate of High-HAA.

• Zone% 41.5%; effective even when missing off plate.

MID HAA (≈2.12°)

• Ball centers in zone (PlateLocSide ≈ –0.05 ft).

• Zone% 73.9%. Whiff% 11.4%.

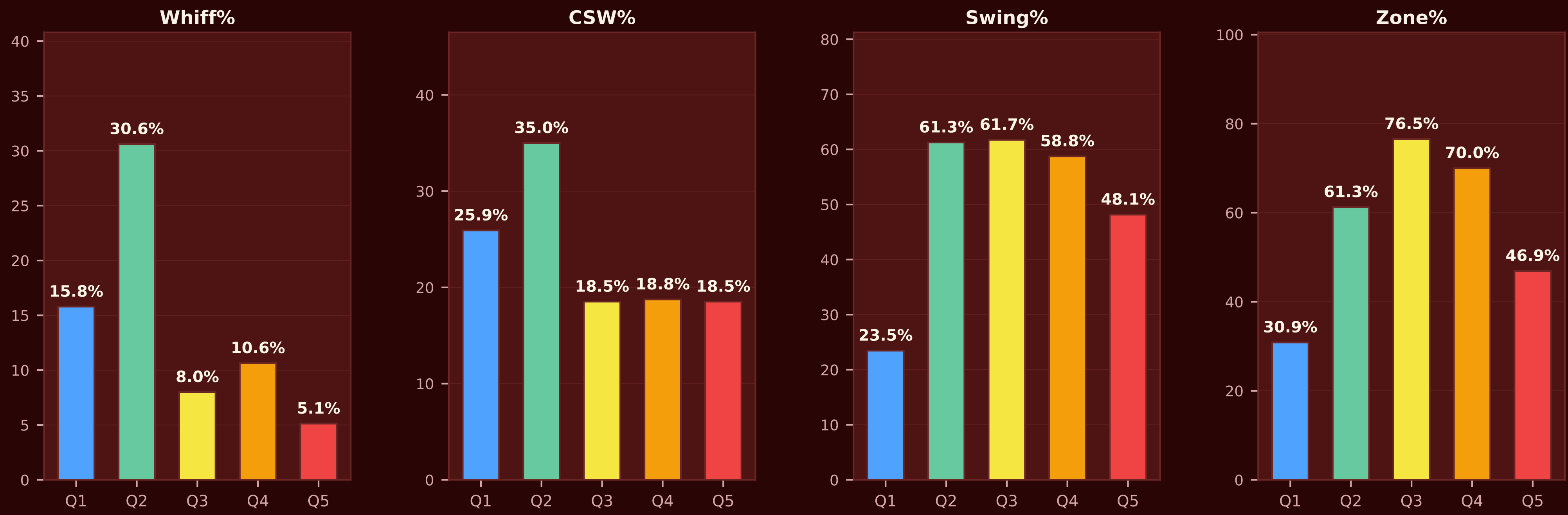
HIGH HAA (≈3.09°)

• Ball runs inside to RHH (PlateLocSide +0.61 ft).

• 8.5% Whiff% — hitters can track and barrel.

• Zone% 56%. Risk of hard contact middle-in.

Beau Elson · 5-Fold HAA Analysis (Quintiles vs RHH)



5-Fold (Quintile) Comparison — Fastball vs RHH

Fold	N	HAA	RelS	RelH	Swing%	Whiff%	CSW%	Zone%	ZTake%	ZSwing%	OSwing%	ZCon%	OCon%
Q1 Low	81	0.78°	-2.25	5.68	23.5%	15.8%	25.9%	30.9%	52.0%	48.0%	12.5%	91.7%	71.4%
Q2	80	1.62°	-2.28	5.63	61.3%	30.6%	35.0%	61.3%	30.6%	69.4%	48.4%	79.4%	46.7%
Q3	81	2.12°	-2.35	5.61	61.7%	8.0%	18.5%	76.5%	21.0%	79.0%	5.3%	91.8%	100.0%
Q4	80	2.58°	-2.38	5.60	58.8%	10.6%	18.8%	70.0%	23.2%	76.8%	16.7%	90.7%	75.0%
Q5 High	81	3.37°	-2.47	5.57	48.1%	5.1%	18.5%	46.9%	26.3%	73.7%	25.6%	100.0%	81.8%

Q1 (lowest HAA, avg 0.78°) → outside to RHH   Q5 (highest HAA, avg 3.37°) → inside to RHH